The Well-Tempered clAIvier

Fugue XXI in B-flat major, twenty-two voices: Capriccio sopra la lontananza

Twenty-two voices (open score): the first twenty-two partials of B-flat

Claude / Sam, after J. S. Bach (BWV 992)

I postiglioni: S at Bach's pitch

Allegro con spirito; alla posta (♩ = 72)

post station

Corno 18 (C6)
Corno 16 (Bb5)
Corno 9 (C5)
Corno 8 (Bb4)
Corno 6 (F4)
Corno 4 (Bb3)
Corno 3 (F3)
Corno 2 (Bb2)

S head on F (F5)
S (B-flat4)
S head on F (F4)
S head on F (F4)
S head on F (F3)
S (B-flat3, Bach's pitch)
A (F3, Bach's pitch; last note B-flat)
A (F2, bass)

10

Schmeichelung: the friends' theme (D minor)

Co18
Co16
Am15
Co12
Am10
Co9
Co8
Co6
Am5
Co4
Co3
Co2
Co1

T answer (A minor, A4)
S head on F (F5)
T (D minor, D5)
T (D minor, D4)
S (B-flat1, the fundamental)

19

I forestieri: Bach's sixth cracks to the 7th partial

Am20
Fo19
Co16
Am15
Fo13
Co12
Am10
Co9
Co8
Fo7
Am5
Co4
Co3
Co2

T answer (A minor, A5)
Bach's head in E-flat; the sixth cracks to the 7th partial
Bach's head in A-flat; the sixth cracks to the 7th partial
Bach's head in B-flat; the sixth cracks to the 7th partial

28

G-flat: the augmented sixth

F, B-flat: the strangers' own partials

lament

Fo21 Am20 Fo17 Co16 Am15 Fo14 Fo13 Fo11 Am10 Co9 Fo7 Co6 Co4 Co3 Co2

Bach's head in F; the sixth cracks to the 7th partial

Bach's head in D-flat; the sixth cracks to the 7th partial

Bach's head in B-flat; the sixth cracks to the 7th partial

Bach's head in G-flat; the sixth cracks to the 7th partial

37

post station on F

Aria with the alphorn fa (11th partial)

rockets in stretto

summit: S and T augmented

Fo22 Fo21 Am20 Fo19 Co18 Fo17 Co16 Am15 Fo14 Fo13 Co12 Fo11 Am10 Co9 Fo7 Co6 Am5 Co4 Co3 Co2 Co1

S head on F (F5)

S head on F (F4)

S head on F (F3)

T x2

A head (Bach's answer, his pitch)

S x2 (B-flat3, Bach's pitch)

Bach's subject in the bass, S and T in stretto

46

T (top; last note C)

A head

S (stretto with Bach, +2 beats; last F held)

S (lands on the cadence)

T (farewell, an octave higher)

T (farewell)

Bach's subject (BWV 992/6), bass

relay up the harmonic series

partials 1-22

the last call